Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
Scarborough Subway Extension, Vice President's Office
Metrolinx, 100 Consilium Place, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Advisor, SSE

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Advisor position in the Scarborough Subway Extension Vice President's Office. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx. Much of this role is preparing the memos, reports, briefing notes and slide decks that move a project's issues to the people who decide them, and that is a large part of what I do now.

At the City I write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions. I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work and holding the schedule myself, and I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict. With policy staff I recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction construction on an operating railway imposes, would do to service. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not prepared Board, Cabinet or Treasury Board submissions, and I have not worked on the delivery team of a major capital project or on contract issues. My project management has been of studies rather than construction. I am applying because the reporting, issues analysis and coordination at the centre of the role is the work I do now.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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